

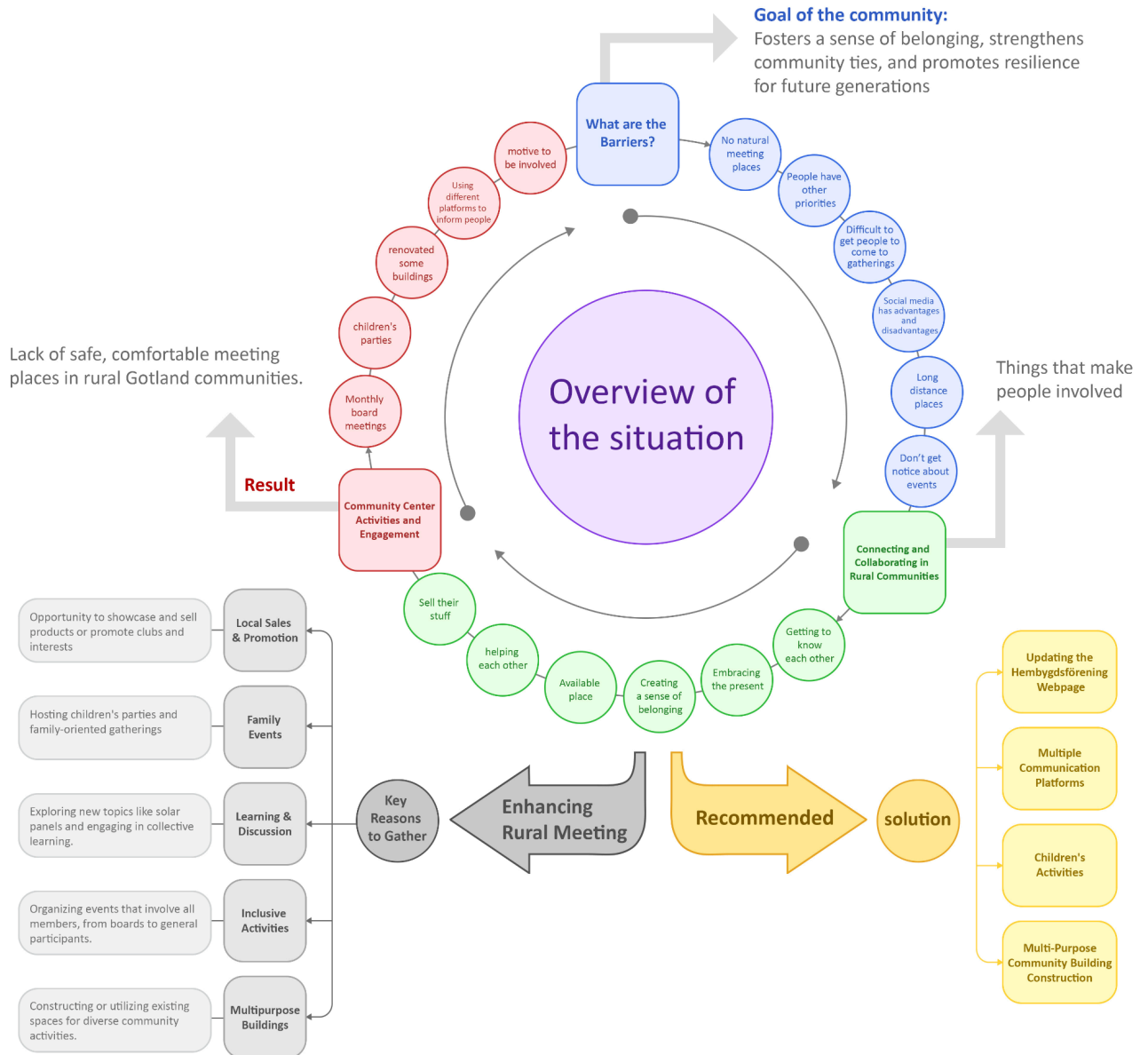
GECO Non-Digital Product Group

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Prototype 1 - Forming Communities Framework: Working towards bringing communities together while balancing the serious and casual aspects of their regular meetups. Informative advertising via infographics.

Overall:

- Hembygd is a homestead organization with dedicated physical locations all around Sweden. It is an already established network that has dedicated physical locations that can be utilized on a very large scale consistently across the country. They have fairly rural locations as well which make them the best contender over custom third party locations which would be more difficult to arrange on a large scale. (<https://www.hembygd.se/shf>)
- We started a questionnaire in order to gather input about what digital or analogue communication channels could feasibly be established for the networking of the communities that need to be formed in order to be able to have energy related local meetings. The results from the questionnaire also serve as basis for decision making regarding the upcoming prototypes which will be towards more practical applications such as revamping and redesigning the Hembygd website on a conceptual level to assist with the meetings and serve as a virtual hub. The other prototype will be focused on building and setting up a facebook group template that will serve as a template for these communities, to be reopened locally by representatives of each town / small district. The link to the questionnaire: <https://forms.gle/nTArTWjRnR2RAiiu8>
- General conceptualization of how frequent the meetings would be, what would be the general template or starting point & content of these meetings be, how would the representatives be selected from towns to attend these meetings, how these representatives can further help to include / add their local community into their local groups / meetings / online spaces etc.
- Supporting activities for balancing the discussions of formal solutions and problems versus informal, more causal and more fun reasons to meet.
- Infographics to raise awareness on a larger scale while also serving as official advertisement for the new communities.



Casual incentives for the meetings:

- **Local sales during meetings:** Promotion of their own products / clubs / interests
- **Family-related events:** Children's parties etc.
- **Learning / Workshops:** Learning about new things such as greener energy alternatives.
- **Local Concerns:** Something that involves everyone, from boards to other members.
- **Events & Their Announcements:** Websites could make it more accessible to hear about the events going around the town, make it more fun and informative so that people frequent the website more often and notice the existing of community meetings & events.

Formal framework/reasons for the meeting:

- Building the template/infrastructure of these meetings, customizing them based on local possibilities and needs.
- Choosing local representatives from smaller locations to gather, and to take on semi-formal leadership roles in local communities to help organize the meetings and network further.

Issues with meeting in person:

- Difficulty with access.
- Lack of incentives to meet.
- Either too informal or too formal, needs to have a balance.
- The difficulty of constructing a multi-purpose building. (Using existing homestead organization locations is a better option. However not every town has them)

Solutions to facilitate difficulties with meeting in person:

- Group calls / video calls
- Analogue & Digital Notice board (Sharing infographics)
- Digital Website HUB of information (Hembygd)
- Facebook groups as HUB for networking and connecting the different nodes of the plan.

Supporting in person meetings with digital network:

- How do we gather the contact information of people in order to add them to these online networks?
- What social media or texting applications does the general targeted adult and elderly demographic prefer to use?

Notes:

Literature review

(https://file.notion.so/f/f/8f548009-ebd8-480f-b28c-31de0b506a74/0e75b43c-a5ab-4591-9143-90017eb68aa8/GECO_GrantApplication.pdf?id=7404d3dd-c9f9-4fdd-b2d9-08e1e98053b4&table=block&spaceId=8f548009-ebd8-480f-b28c-31de0b506a74&expirationTimestamp=1711382400000&signature=HwRPZuleemDeIyCs1n-CbzSrZ4byn2VcwCgadVVuoCU&downloadName=GECO_GrantApplication.pdf)

Energicentrum Gotland is a good way to distribute gamified toolkits to help communities. Elderly female population on Gotland is especially at risk of being left out of the digital solutions so it is important to pay attention to accessibility.

“5.1 Platform and Channels Study PATRICK DAHL To ensure our ability to scale outreach and marketing efforts, we will study the platforms and communications most effective for reaching our target audience. The review's outcome is to determine the best channels and media of communication to reach rural communities. For our coaching and community platform to have the most significant possible impact across Gotland and all of Sweden, we need to meet people where they are. Knowing on what platforms and through which modalities rural communities learn, communicate, and collaborate empowers us to design and distribute our material best for those using it.” -> We had to make a questionnaire ourselves since we could not find info from this.

Interviews

The notes outline various barriers to community engagement in rural areas, such as differences in thinking, lack of natural meeting places, and people's prioritization of other activities. They highlight the challenges of using social media effectively and the need to make gatherings appealing and inclusive. Solutions discussed include organizing events for children, utilizing community centers, improving communication through various platforms, holding regular board meetings, fostering motivation, evaluating new attractions, and renovating buildings and multi-purpose spaces. These efforts aim to address issues of social isolation, lack of belonging, and limited participation in community activities.

Solutions:

The solution being presented is based on our observation firmly grounded in comprehensive data analysis and research.

Option 1:

Updating the Hembygdsförening Webpage:

Improve the website that already exists, like the info on the location and building, what events are going to happen there and such

- **Examples:**

Content Updates and Organization:

- Regularly update the website content with the latest news, events, and activities organized by the Hembygdsförening on a country scale.
- Organize content into relevant sections such as "About Us", "Local Events Calendar", "Projects", "Membership", and "Contact Us" for easy access and the centralization of everything..
- Providing detailed information about the history, mission, and objectives of the association to engage visitors and potential members.

Interactive Features:

- Incorporate interactive features like an events calendar where users can view upcoming activities, RSVP, and share events on social media platforms.
- Include a photo gallery showcasing past events, historical landmarks, and community projects to visually engage visitors.

Community Engagement:

- Integrate social media widgets or feeds to display real-time updates from social media channels, encouraging visitors to follow and engage with the association online.
- Include a community forum or discussion board where members can interact, share ideas, and collaborate on projects.

Option 2:

Multiple Communication Platforms:

Utilize a combination of traditional and digital communication channels, including mail, social media (like Facebook groups), email newsletters, and community websites, to disseminate information about upcoming events, initiatives, and community news.

- **Example:** Construct or reuse a community center equipped with meeting rooms, a recreational area for children, a space for cultural events, and facilities for hosting workshops or classes. This building could also include a café or small shop to encourage socializing and support local businesses.

Option 3:

Children's Activities:

Develop programs and events specifically tailored to children, such as parties, workshops, and educational activities, to encourage families to participate in community gatherings.

- **Example:** Organize regular children's parties with themed activities, games, and snacks. Offer workshops on arts and crafts, storytelling sessions, or outdoor adventures like nature walks or treasure hunts.

Option 4:

Multi-Purpose Community Building Construction:

Build a multi-purpose community center that serves as a hub for various activities and gatherings. This facility should accommodate diverse needs, including spaces for meetings, events, children's activities, and socializing.

- **Example:** Construct a community center equipped with meeting rooms, a recreational area for children, a space for cultural events, and facilities for hosting workshops or classes. This building could also include a café or small shop to encourage socializing and support local businesses.